



ART

- **"art"** French word = skill or result of practice
- **"ars"** Latin word = ability/ practice skills process, product or ability
- It takes an **artist** to make art. One may perceive beauty on a daily basis.
- **Not every beautiful thing** that can be seen or experienced may truly be called a work of art.
- Product of man's creativity, imagination, and expression.
- Not everyone can be considered an artist, but all are **spectators** of art.

"The role of art as a creative work is to depict the world in a completely different light and perspective" – **Jean-Paul Sartre**

ART APPRECIATION AS A WAY OF LIFE

- Each artwork beholds beauty in its own kind, the kind that the artist sees and wants the viewers to perceive.
- Only those who have **developed a fine sense of appreciation** can experience and see the art the way the artist did.
- Refining one's ability to appreciate arts allows him to deeply understand the purpose of an artwork and recognize the beauty it possesses.
- One should also exercise and develop his taste for things that are fine and beautiful.
- This allows individuals to make intelligent choices and decisions in acquiring necessities and luxuries, knowing what gives better value for time or money while taking into consideration the aesthetic and practical value.

Creativity

- **Requires thinking outside the box.**
- **What sets apart one artwork from another.**
- **Originality.**

ART AS A PRODUCT OF IMAGINATION, IMAGINATION AS A PRODUCT OF ART

"Imagination is more important than knowledge. For knowledge is limited to all we now know and understand, while imagination embraces the entire world, and all there ever will be to know and understand." – **Albert Einstein**

- **Imagination** is not constrained by the walls of the norm but goes beyond that.
- One is able to craft something bold, something new, and something better in the hopes of creating something that will stimulate change.
- In an artist's mind sits a vast **gallery of artworks**.
- An artwork **does not need to be a real thing** but can be something imaginary.
- Artists use their imagination, which gives birth to reality through creation.
- Imagination allows endless possibilities.

ART AS EXPRESSION

"What an artist does to an emotion is not to induce it, but express it. Through expression, he is able to explore his own emotions and at the same time, create something beautiful out of them." – **Robin George Collingwood**

- **Expressing emotions** is different from describing emotions.
- This makes people's art not a reflection of what is outside or external to them, but a reflection of their inner selves.

Visual Art

- **Paintings** application of pigment in any flat two dimensional surface.
- **Sculpture** carving, modelling, casting
- **Architecture** art/science of planning

Film aesthetic cultural social value, both art and industry

Performance Art live art, human body

Literary Works / Poetry form of writing/speech

Architecture designing, constructing buildings

Dance series of movements

Theater live performers to present imaginary events

Applied Arts elements of style and design to everyday items

ASSUMPTIONS AND NATURE OF ART

Art is Universal

- Transcends culture, races and civilizations
- art exists in all cultures and time periods.

Art as a means of communication

- Expressing their thoughts and feelings through arts like music, dances, literary pieces, decorative arts, paintings and drawings, sculptures and others.
- communicates **stories, emotions, values**—not with numbers, but with color, sound, or motion.

Art is Timeless

- It continually evolves. (Ex: *Classical music*) for **art survives trends**—because it speaks to the core of human life.

Art Addresses Human Needs

- It addresses the needs of people from all over the world. – **comfort, entertainment and education.**
- Art responds to our **need to feel, express, reflect, and belong**—just like business responds to human needs through services and solutions.

Art is not nature

- **art is man-made.** It is a creation of man that may reflect a profound skillfulness and craftsmanship. It undergoes process and planning: a result of study and research.
- You **design it, structure it, and interpret it.**

Art is innate

- The beauty of nature is silent. It is given. it doesn't ask for attention since it is naturally part of it, while it is true that beauty in art demands human attention for it leads us to its valuation.

Art involves experience

- Art is a representation of our experiences. It demands **involvement.** The only way to

find conviction and affirmation in art is through immersion in the arts.

- **visual design, tone, audience connection, and impact—**

Prehistoric Period

- **Carvings** - stone, coal; survival - life hunting animals

Ancient Period

- **Pyramid** - **Egyptian, Sculptures**
Leadership, Civilization, Religion

Medieval Period

- **Religious artwork, Mosaic** - **glass painting**

Renaissance Period

- **Rebirth ; paintings, Da Vinci | Picasso**

Digital Art

- AI/Canva

FUNCTION OF ARTS

Telos

- Purpose / end goal
- Aristotle claimed that every particular substance in the world has an end, or telos in Greek, which translates into purpose.
- Telos is intricately linked with function: For a thing to reach its purpose, it also has to fulfill its function.
- isn't just 'what something does' – it's what it was **meant to do.**

Functions of Art

- An **inquiry** on the function of art is an inquiry on what art is for.
- There is no one-to-one correspondence between an art and its function. Some art forms are more functional than others.

PERSONAL

- function of art is being fulfilled when an artist expresses personal feelings or mental state through their work.
- subjective, therapeutic (*diary, love song, poem, drawings*)

SOCIAL

- raises awareness and challenges societal issues

- addresses particular collective interest opposed to personal interest, protest (*political morals, film that challenges gender stereotypes, play about poverty/injustice*)

PHYSICAL

- Serves practical purpose while conveying deeper meaning
- They are crafted in order to serve some physical purpose. *Architecture, jewelry-making and even interior design* are all forms of arts that have physical function.
- *Bahay Kubo* , *Handcrafted Jewelry*, *UP oblation statue*
- *Music* - facilitate worship, self expression, stage plays
- *Sculpture* - commemorate important figures in history, feature hero/personality ; coins
- *Architecture* - most prominent, buildings are not easily constructed ; **function & form** consideration of natural conditions & social

GEARTS+ COMPREHENSIVE REVIEWER

Lessons 4-6: Philosophical Perspectives on Art · Artists and Artisans · Subject and Content

LESSON 4: PHILOSOPHICAL PERSPECTIVES ON ART

1. Art as Imitation – Plato

Plato viewed art as **imitation or mimesis**. Art is copying what we see, while what we see is already a copy of the "perfect" reality in the World of Forms.

- Art becomes an imitation of an imitation.
- Example: A painting of a tree is a copy of the tree we see; that tree is an imperfect copy of the perfect tree in the World of Forms.
- Plato was suspicious of arts and artists because they appeal to emotion rather than reason and imitate rather than learn one reality.
- He advised against including art as a subject in the curriculum and against artists being included in the Republic.
- Poetry can rouse emotions and feelings and cloud people's rationality.

2. Art as Representation – Aristotle

Aristotle considered art a form of imitation, but saw it as an **aid to philosophy** in revealing truth.

- Art can provide a vision of what might be and the possibilities in reality.
- Art can give pleasure.
- Art can instruct and teach audiences things about life.
- Example: *Inside Out* is not literally real, but can help people understand emotions in real life.

3. Disinterested Judgment – Immanuel Kant

Kant considered the **judgment of beauty** the cornerstone of art. Beauty is subjective, yet subjective judgments can have a universal quality.

- "I like this painting" = personal taste.
- "This painting is beautiful" = a judgment believed to be recognizable by others.
- After perception and the free play of faculties, people should recognize beauty inherent in a work of art.

4. Art as Communication of Emotion – Leo Tolstoy

Tolstoy viewed art as a **language and communication device** that articulates feelings and emotions otherwise unavailable to the audience.

- Art connects artist and audience through shared feelings.
- Example: A love song can make people emotional even without having experienced love.
- *Coco* can make audiences feel nostalgic about family.

5. Art as Communication of Information

- Art can communicate important messages, not only beauty or feelings.
- Art can serve as a mechanism for social unity and cohesion.
- Examples include political murals, environmental murals, social justice art, and street art during protests.
- Art can inform, unite, and inspire action.

Lesson 4 Quick Memory Guide

PLATO → Imitation **ARISTOTLE** → Representation **KANT** → Beauty/Judgment **TOLSTOY** → Emotion
INFORMATION → Message/Unity

LESSON 5: ARTISTS AND ARTISANS

1. Artist

An artist performs forms of creative art and creates art using **imagination** with **aesthetic value**.

- Examples: painter, sculptor, choreographer, dancer, musician.
- An artist can create art for the sake of art itself.
- Artists can help society envision thoughts that may not be tolerated within existing social and political paradigms.

2. Artisan

An artisan is essentially a **manual worker** who makes items with their hands through skill, experience, and talent.

- Creates things of beauty as well as functional or decorative works.
- Examples: carpenter, carver, plumber, blacksmith, weaver, embroiderer.

3. Artist vs. Artisan

Artist	Artisan
Creative art practitioner; uses imagination; aesthetic value. Examples: painter, sculptor, dancer, musician.	Craftsman/manual worker; uses skill, experience, and talent; directly functional and/or decorative arts.

Key statement: An artist is not an artisan, and vice versa.

4. Artisan Guilds

- Guilds became prevalent during the Middle Ages.
- Specializations included shoemakers, textiles, glass workers, carpenters, carvers, masons, armor makers, and weapon makers.
- Guilds were social fellowships or associations with rules, customs, rights, and responsibilities.
- Master artisans developed extensive expertise and could hire apprentices for tutelage and instruction.

5. Two Major Awards Given to Philippine Artists

- Orden ng Pambansang Alagad ng Sining (Order of National Artists)
- Gawad sa Manlilikha ng Bayan (National Living Treasures Award)

6. Order of National Artists

The Order of National Artists is the highest National Recognition given to Filipino individuals who made significant contributions to Philippine arts.

- Fields: Music, Dance, Theater, Visual Arts, Literature, Film and Broadcast Arts, Architecture or Allied Arts.
- Bestowed by the President of the Philippines on Philippine nationals who made significant contributions to Philippine art.
- Jointly administered by the NCCA and CCP; conferred by the President upon recommendation by both institutions.
- First recipient: Fernando Amorsolo in 1972, National Artist for Visual Arts.

GEARTS+ COMPREHENSIVE REVIEWER

Lessons 4-6: Philosophical Perspectives on Art · Artists and Artisans · Subject and Content

7. Insignia and Privileges of National Artists

- Insignia means a badge of authority or honor.
- The insignia includes a Grand Collar, circular links portraying the arts, an eight-pointed sunburst, a sampaguita wreath, and a central medallion.
- The central badge recalls the Philippine flag and contains three stylized Ks.
- **KKK** = katotohanan, kabutihan, at kagandahan – the true, the good, and the beautiful.
- Privileges: rank and title; medallion/insignia and citation; cash awards and benefits including pension, medical/hospitalization, and life insurance coverage; state funeral and burial at the Libingan ng mga Bayani; place of honor during national state functions and recognition at cultural events.

8. Gawad sa Manlilikha ng Bayan (GAMABA)

GAMABA recognizes a person or group of artists for contributions to the country's intangible cultural heritage.

- Recognizes traditional artists whose skills and knowledge reach high technical and artistic excellence.
- Helps keep traditions, ingenuity, culture, and identity alive for future generations.
- The NCCA has awarded exemplary Filipinos for GAMABA since 1992.
- The award follows UNESCO's criteria of Living National Treasures.
- Areas include weaving, carving, graphic and plastic arts, textile, pottery, and other artistic expressions of traditional culture.
- Created in 1992 under RA No. 7355 by the NCCA.

9. Apo Whang-Od

- Identified with the traditional Batok tattoo practice.
- She has been hand-tapping tattoos since she was a teenager.
- She is described as a mambabatok of her generation.
- Her practice helps keep an ancient Filipino tradition alive and is associated with Filipino history and identity.

10. GAMABA Incentives and Privileges

- Specially designed gold medallion.
- Initial grant of PHP 100,000 and a monthly stipend for life; later increased to PHP 14,000.
- Maximum cumulative amount of PHP 750,000 in medical and hospitalization benefits.
- Funeral assistance and tribute fit for a National Living Treasure.

LESSON 6: SUBJECT AND CONTENT

1. Appreciating Art

- A barrier to enjoying art is believing that one must find a specific image, understand the artist's exact intention, and uncover one clear meaning.
- This can wrongly limit art appreciation to people trained in creating or interpreting art.
- This should not be the case.

2. Perception

Perception is the **primary stage** of engaging with art. Engagement begins through looking at the artwork.

- Awareness during the process of looking is important.
- Subjectivity is essential in navigating through an artwork.

3. Subjectivity

Selective perception can make one or two details more prominent than others, causing viewers to focus on certain details as essential or standout elements.

- Personal perspective is key to understanding an artwork.
- Example: In M.C. Escher's *Relativity*, the objective illusion is physics-defying space, while subjective readings may include confusion, complexity, or absurdity of life.
- In René Magritte's *The Treachery of Images*, the objective message is that the image is not a real pipe; subjective readings may include a philosophical statement, joke, or rebellion against realism.

4. Three Basic Components of a Work of Art

SUBJECT	CONTENT	FORM
= WHAT	= WHY	= HOW

5. Subject

Subject is the visual focus or image extracted from examining an artwork – the "what."

- It is what is literally shown in the artwork.
- Example: *Mona Lisa* – a portrait of a woman, Lisa Gherardini, sitting with a faint smile.

6. Content

Content is the meaning communicated by the artist or artwork – the "why."

- Example: *Guernica* – the horrors, pain, and chaos caused by the bombing of Guernica during the Spanish Civil War.
- The emotional and political statement is emphasized even though the figures are distorted.

7. Form

Form is the development and configuration of the artwork, including how elements and medium/materials are put together – the "how."

Example: *The Starry Night* – swirling brushstrokes, bold colors, expressive texture, rhythm, movement, composition, technique, and visual style.

8. Types of Subject

- **Representational Art** refers to objects or events occurring in the real world. Also called figurative art because figures are easy to make out and decipher.
- **Non-representational Art** does not refer to a real-world person, place, thing, or event. Uses shapes, lines, and colors to translate feelings, emotions, or concepts. Also called non-figurative art.

9. Representational → Abstract → Non-representational

- Representational art shows recognizable things from real life.

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- Abstract art begins from something real but changes, distorts, or simplifies it.
- Non-representational art has no real-world subject and is separated from the real world.
- The three exist on a spectrum rather than as a simple clear-cut divide.
- Example: realistic tree → representational; distorted tree of swirling lines → abstract; random shapes/colors with no tree → non-representational.

10. Pablo Picasso and Vasily Kandinsky

- **Head of a Woman** – Pablo Picasso: distorted/cut-metal work that remains recognizable as a head of a woman, illustrating representational art despite abstraction.
- **Vasily Kandinsky**: Russian artist and proponent of non-representational art; used it with music. Many works were inspired by music and titled *Impression*, *Improvisation*, and *Composition*.

11. Sources of Subject

- **Nature** – examples include works by Vincent van Gogh, Claude Monet, Camille Pissarro, Paul Cézanne, Fernando Amorsolo, and Fabian Dela Rosa.
- Greek and Roman Mythology
- Judeo-Christian Tradition
- Sacred Oriental Texts
- History
- Artists' subject choices can be influenced by commissioners, popular styles, artistic standards, and social trends in the artist's environment.

12. Content and Erwin Panofsky

Content is the meaning or message expressed or communicated by an artwork. Erwin Panofsky is identified as a leading scholar who explained content analysis in *Meaning in the Visual Arts* (1983).

13. Levels of Meaning

- **Factual Meaning** – what you see or know for sure; basic, obvious, objective, and verifiable information. Example: "There is a red apple on a table."
- **Conventional Meaning** – acknowledged interpretation using motifs, signs, symbols, and other clues; shared or cultural meaning. Example: a red apple may represent health or knowledge.
- **Subjective Meaning** – personal meaning based on feelings, memories, experiences, background, knowledge, and values. Different people can see different meanings in the same artwork.

14. Motif and Conventional Meaning

A **motif** is an element of an image. It can appear in figurative, narrative, ornamental, or geometrical art and may be repeated or appear once.

- Conventions develop through time, recurrent use, and wide acceptance by viewers and scholars.
- They are shaped by tradition, custom, and social norms.

15. Subjective Meaning

- Subjective meaning is personal and varies from viewer to viewer.
- It can come from what a viewer knows, learned, experienced, and values.
- Example: an apple may remind one viewer of a grandmother's kitchen and mean "home" or "comfort."
- Meaning may not be singular; it may be multiple and varied.

MASTER MEMORY GUIDE

Lesson 4

Plato → Imitation • Aristotle → Representation • Kant → Disinterested Judgment • Tolstoy → Communication of Emotion • Information → Message/Unity

Lesson 5

Artist → Creative/Aesthetic/Imagination • Artisan → Craftsmanship/Functional or Decorative • Order of National Artists → Highest National Recognition • GAMABA → National Living Treasures

Lesson 6

Perception → Primary engagement • Subject → WHAT • Content → WHY • Form → HOW • Representational → Real-world subject • Abstract → Distorted/simplified reality • Non-representational → No real-world subject • Factual → Objective • Conventional → Shared cultural • Subjective → Personal